

1

Marxism: a set of political and economic principles founded by Marx and Engels to give socialism a scientific basis through historical analysis of conflict between antagonistic classes. (PDF p.47)

2

Marx and Engels: founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production. (PDF p.47)

3

Start with Marxism as scientific socialism responding to capitalist exploitation. (PDF pp.46-47)

4

Classical Marxism: the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation. (PDF p.47)

The Classical Marxist Argument and Essential Distinctions

1

Gauba presents classical Marxism through four main tenets: dialectical materialism, historical materialism, class conflict and surplus value. (PDF p.48, p.52)

2

Classical Marxism: the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation. (PDF p.47)

3

Neo-Marxism: later Marxist thought that studies subtler forms of dominance, alienation and paths to human emancipation. (PDF p.47, p.53)

4

Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism: classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination. (PDF pp.47, 53-54)

1

Read together: exploitation (surplus value), domination (state as class instrument) and dehumanization (alienation) are three faces of the same underlying property relation, not three unrelated Marxist claims — a strong answer connects them rather than listing them separately.

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For UPSC purposes, the topic moves from economy-centred critique to a wider analysis of ideology, culture and domination.

4

Marxism explains why formal legal equality can coexist with deep economic inequality under capitalism. (PDF pp.46-47)

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Neo-Marxism shows why domination cannot be reduced only to factory ownership; culture, communication and ideology also matter. (PDF pp.53-54)

3

Forces of production vs relations of production: forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations. (PDF pp.48-49)

4

Neo-Marxist cultural critique treats communication and consumer desire as sites of domination, not merely reflections of factory ownership. (PDF pp.53-54)

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Historical materialism: the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life. (PDF p.48)

3

Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism: the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society. (PDF p.48)

4

Historical materialism restated as a mechanism: economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gauba, PDF p.48).

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Mechanism: when forces of production outgrow existing relations of production, the relations become a fetter that is broken by revolution, producing a new social formation (§12); this economic-class mechanism operates through and is reproduced by state power as a class instrument (§13) and is experienced by individuals as alienation (§13). Neo-Marxists (§14) extend the mechanism by adding

3

Antonio Gramsci — cross-referenced from Gauba's treatment of hegemony in the power/authority chapter (Gauba, PDF pp.306, 309-311), rather than from the Marxism chapter's own PDF pp.46-54 range — adds hegemony, civil society and structures of legitimation to explain why capitalist rule survives through consent as well as coercion: capitalist class power is secured not only through the

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Key citation anchors used here: Marxism and classical/neo distinction (PDF p.47); main tenets, base-superstructure, forces/relations and class stages (PDF pp.48-52); neo-Marxism, Frankfurt School and Marcuse/Althusser/dependency theorists (PDF pp.53-54); Gramsci on hegemony and civil society (PDF pp.306, 309-311).

3

Frankfurt School: Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique. (PDF p.53)

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Althusser, Dependency Theory and Classification Cautions

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The Habermas generation caveat (§14.2) and the dependency/world-systems classification caution (§14.4) are flagged specifically because they are standard scholarly clarifications, not independently page-anchored against the Marxism chapter's own PDF pp.46-54 range; do not upgrade them to status or attach a specific book title/year/page without independent verification.

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4

Louis Althusser: represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production. (PDF p.54)

Objections, Qualified Thesis, Evidence and Doctrine Architecture

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Indian Application, Mark-Scaled Answers and Proposition Discipline

1

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2

When an Indian policy debate is framed only as a technical/administrative matter, the non-mechanical base-superstructure relation (§12) and Gramscian hegemony (§14.1) together supply the question of whether an apparently neutral legal or administrative arrangement is doing quiet work to protect an existing economic arrangement — to be paired with the candidate's own independently verified

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For answer-writing, a safe illustration is to compare direct workplace exploitation with indirect ideological consent produced through culture and media.